

Alisa Liao

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EDUCATION

University of California San Diego, Revelle College

Expected June 2029

B.S. in Cognitive Science GPA: 3.953

La Jolla, CA

Coursework: Research Methods, Neurobiology of Cognition, Data Science in Practice, Cognitive Consequences of Technology, Design at Large

Mission San Jose High School

June 2025

Valedictorian | 150+ Service Hours

Fremont, CA

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, HTML, CSS

Skills: Designing and Executing Human Behavior Experiments, Data Analysis, Event Organization, Working With Kids

Tools: Adobe Photoshop, Figma, CAD 3D Modelling, Qualtrics

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

Jan 2026 – Present

Emotions and Empathy Lab, UC San Diego

La Jolla, CA

- Contribute to study on social interactions examining how emotion suppression and expression affect interpersonal closeness
- Facilitate experiments by guiding participants through protocols to ensure high-quality, unbiased data collection
- Assist in study design by collecting pilot data and providing input on experimental methodology
- Develop a comprehensive codebook standardizing survey variables to streamline data analysis and ensure consistency across datasets

IDEA Intern

April 2026 – Present

Design For America, UC San Diego

La Jolla, CA

- Improve IDEA, Design For America's program for members of all skill levels to work with different non-profit organizations and gain design skills
- Prepare knowledge and experience to become IDEA program leads next quarter, bringing opportunities and community to the next generation of designers at UCSD

Scientific Illustrator

Oct 2025 – Present

Saltman Quarterly Research Journal, UC San Diego

La Jolla, CA

- Increase accessibility of published research by creating complementary illustrations for a peer-reviewed science journal
- Collaborate with authors and editors to improve readability and transparency in scientific communication

Graphic Design Intern

Sep 2025 – May 2026

Revelle Creatives, UC San Diego

La Jolla, CA

- Completed design projects commissioned by Revelle College organizations, building client communication experience

Music and Art Branch Director & Volunteer Tutor

Aug 2021 – Jul 2025

BOBTutor

Remote

- Directed Music and Art Branch for nonprofit, promoting accessibility of arts education for children
- Led online fundraising events raising over \$2,000 for Tshepang Care Center serving orphaned children in South Africa
- Implemented and managed a system of virtual music and art lessons, integrating both education and fundraising initiatives
- Taught singing and art to children aged 5–9

PROJECTS

Brilliance Exposed Website Redesign | *Figma, User Research*

Sep 2025 – Present

- Selected via Design For America to redesign website for Brilliance Exposed, a nonprofit photography exhibition
- Build high-fidelity Figma prototypes with team, improving aesthetics, user experience, and professional appearance
- Plan to build a functioning website based off of our user research and Figma prototypes

Fremont BoxART! Public Art | *Mural Design, Painting*

May – Jul 2024

- Selected by City of Fremont to design and paint a public electrical box as part of a citywide beautification initiative
- Created visually compelling design promoting sustainability and upcycling for a community engagement program

ACTIVITIES

Volunteer | *Brain Exercise Initiative*

Oct 2025 – Present

- Facilitate math, reading, and writing exercises with elderly residents at retirement homes to support cognitive health

Volunteer | *TCV Food Bank*

Jun – Sep 2025

- Collaborated with 6-person team to distribute food at a community center serving over 10,000 individuals monthly

Volunteer | *The Tech Interactive, San Jose*

Dec 2023 – Jan 2024

- Engaged visitors of all ages with interactive STEAM exhibits, maintaining safety and educational standards

Private Tutor | *Math & English, Ages 5–8*

Dec 2023 – Jan 2026

- Taught children according to demonstrated skill level, adapting curriculum to individual learning needs